What changed in the last 30 hours

Groundwork by Jalla · 27–28 October 2026 · from Favour

FOR RUTH

Forty-five changes went in between yesterday morning and this morning. Most of them you will never notice. Three of them change what you do today, and one of them changes what every contractor on the platform sees the next time they log in. This report is written so you can act on it without reading any code.

1 The one thing that needs you today

> **40 contractors cannot get into Groundwork until they re-sign**
>
> We replaced the document contractors sign during onboarding. The old one was the **Partner Agreement**; the new one is a **Contractor Terms of Service**. A signature on the old document no longer counts as finishing onboarding, so anyone who signed the old one is sent back to step 1 and the sidebar is locked until they sign the new one.
>
> **This is deliberate, not a bug.** It is the decision we took to stop relying on the old agreement. But it means 40 people will open Groundwork and find themselves back at the start.

51	11	40	0
REAL CONTRACTORS	SIGNED THE NEW TERMS	MUST RE-SIGN	MID-PROJECT

The good news is the last number. I checked every one of the 40 against live project assignments: none of them is currently working on a project through Groundwork. So no client is left without site updates while this happens, and nobody's build is interrupted. It is an inconvenience, not a loss.

Re-signing takes about thirty seconds — open the document, tick the box, type your name. What it needs from us is a message warning them before they discover it themselves.

2 The new Contractor Terms of Service

Philip supplied the document yesterday. It is now what every contractor signs at onboarding, and it is live on the database.

Why we swapped it

Until yesterday a contractor had to sign the *Partner Agreement* to finish onboarding — even someone with no diaspora clients, no interest in referrals and no expectation of commission. That agreement promises **$50 per project per month**. 62 people hold a signature on it. The promise was withdrawn commercially months ago; the signatures stayed.

The new document fixes that at the root. Section 5 says plainly that holding a Contractor Account is **not** partner status and carries no right to referrals, project assignments or compensation. Partner status now requires a separate application, which is what the partner form is for.

DOCUMENT	WHO SIGNS IT	WHEN	STATUS
Contractor Terms of Service	Every contractor	Onboarding, step 1	LIVE
Partner Agreement	Partners only	Not yet collected anywhere	NEEDS A HOME
Contractor Privacy Notice	Acknowledged by all	Referenced but missing	DOES NOT EXIST

> **Two gaps worth knowing about**
>
> **Nothing collects the Partner Agreement any more.** It is still a valid, signable document, but since it came out of onboarding there is no screen that asks for it. If accepted partners are meant to sign it, that step needs building.
>
> **The Privacy Notice does not exist.** The acceptance statement has contractors acknowledge a "Contractor Privacy Notice" by name, and the terms incorporate it by reference. There is no such document. The link currently points at our general privacy page.

3 Contractor onboarding, rebuilt

The whole five-step sequence was reworked with Philip on the call. The biggest structural change is the lock; the rest is wording.

The sidebar is now locked until onboarding is finished

A contractor can see every menu item — Dashboard, My projects, Payment details and the rest — but cannot open any of them until all five steps are done. Typing the address directly does not get past it either. Previously someone could sign the agreement and then wander off mid-setup.

What each step says now

STEP	CHANGED TO
1 · Agreement	Now reads **"Groundwork Terms of Service"**, not "Partner Agreement and Terms of Service". A privacy policy link sits beneath it. The line "Nothing else is asked of you until this is done" was removed.
2 · About you	Explanatory subtext removed. The address field now shows an example: *"e.g. Mile 16, Limbe — near the Poly Clinic, South West Region, Cameroon"*.
3 · Specialty	Subtext removed. Choosing "Other" no longer shows a separate label and hint — the examples now sit inside the box itself.
4 · Payment	Question renamed to **"How you get paid for projects"**. New subtext: "Clients can pay you directly through Groundwork. Provide your preferred method of receiving payment." The explanation under the dialog heading was removed.
5 · Emergency contact	New wording: *"In case of an emergency, who is your preferred person of contact? That could be your family member, a trusted friend or spouse."* The phone hint was removed.
Final screen	"You're all set" became **"You're almost there"**. The two buttons are now **"Create a project"** and **"I don't have a project"**.

Everything above exists in English and French.

4 The partner application

Philip's main concern on the call was that an applicant could see the whole branching structure at once and therefore work out which answers get them through. The form now reveals one question at a time; the next question only appears after the previous one is answered.

QUESTION	WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

Do you have an active project?	Three options. Each leads somewhere different.
→ Already running	Asks what stage the project is in
→ About to start	Asks when it will start
→ No project	**Disqualified.** The form is replaced by an explanation.
Can the client come on site daily?	**Yes disqualifies.** No asks why not.
Would you use Groundwork?	**No disqualifies.**
Worked with diaspora clients?	Yes or No. Yes reveals a box to describe it; No moves straight on.

Selecting an answer advances on its own — no Next button to press. The page headline is now **"Onboard your first project, and become a certified partner"**, and underneath: *"Groundwork certified partners are eligible to receive projects from Groundwork, plus free lifetime access to the Groundwork platform. Fill out the application below to be considered."*

When someone becomes a certified partner — the rule Philip set out

This came up because you asked, and the answer changes who you chase and when.

- **Every project comes onto Groundwork.** A local client's build is a regular project. Nothing about it is second-class.
- **Only a diaspora client project leads to certified partner status.** That is what makes a project "approved" for this purpose.
- **The partner conversation happens after the project is live on Groundwork**, not at the point the contractor mentions having one. Those contractors go to a call with Philip, who sets out the full scope of the partnership.

> **"Active project" means two different things, and the difference matters**
>
> A project can be active **on site** — land bought, design underway, builders arriving — and still not be active **on Groundwork**. It is only active on Groundwork when the contractor is actually running it through the platform.
>
> So when you ask a contractor "do you have an active project?", you are asking whether a build is really going ahead. When we say *Groundwork active* internally, we mean they are using the platform for it. A contractor who has finished land and moved into design has a live build and no Groundwork activity at all — those are pre-planning phases.
>
> Philip's instruction: let them get the project onto Groundwork and running before moving them into a partner conversation. The one contractor you already promised a partner application to can go ahead — that promise stands. Everyone after that follows the new order.

> **Your disqualification message has not reached me**
>
> The three stop messages currently in the product are ones we wrote, not the copy you mentioned sharing. If yours is meant to replace them, send it and I will put it in. The three cases are: no project, client can be on site daily, and would not use Groundwork.

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5 Signup and account emails

- The signup page title is now **"Sign up to manage your project."**
- The explanations under the email and phone fields are gone, on both the client and contractor forms.

- After signing up, the page shows **only** the "Check your email" message. The heading and the Client/Contractor choice disappear, so nobody can switch role after the account exists.
- The confirmation wording is now: *"We sent a confirmation link to [email]. Follow the link in your email to complete your account setup."*
- The spacing between the role choice and the first field now matches on both forms.

> **Account emails were sending people to a test address**
>
> The "Confirm email address" message was showing `groundwork1-phl.vercel.app` instead of tryjalla.com — and not only in the footer. **The confirmation button itself used that address**, so new contractors were confirming their accounts on a test deployment rather than the real site.
>
> The email templates are fixed. The remaining piece is a setting in our Supabase dashboard that only Favour or Philip can change. Until it is changed, some account emails may still carry the wrong link.

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6 Everything else that moved

Work you did not ask for but should know happened, because it touches what clients and contractors see:

- **Plans and prices came out.** The subscription tab, the Jalla Verify checkout and the paid-tier logic were removed from the client side. One contractor reported still seeing plans — that may be the deployment delay rather than a leftover.
- **Project wizard.** The budget figure can now be edited properly (it used to snap back when you tried to clear it), target start and end dates were added, and the country list was reordered so Cameroon, Nigeria and Ghana come first.
- **Bill of quantities and floor plans.** Work is underway so that a contractor who already has these documents does not have to re-enter the project details. This is the structural job Philip named as the top priority. It is not finished — the totals are still coming out wrong.
- **"Project manager" was added** as a contractor role.
- **An onboarding acknowledgement email** was added.

The things you reported, and where each one stands

WHAT YOU SAW	WHERE IT STANDS
Countries listed alphabetically — Angola, Benin, Botswana at the top	Fixed. Cameroon, Nigeria and Ghana now come first. You were seeing the deployment delay, not a broken fix.
Budget figure bounces back when you try to clear it	Fixed. You can now delete it and type your own number.
The country page flashes up when you click "create project"	Known. It resolves itself and lands on the right project, but it should not happen.
Subscription plans still showing for a contractor	Plans were removed. May also be the deployment delay — worth a recheck now.
Contractor directory not locked	Agreed it should be locked until someone has fully onboarded. Built, not yet shipped.
Bill of quantities total reading 73 trillion	Real and unresolved. The underlying document totalled 59 million.
Multiple floor plans	Now works — "add more" accepts several files.

Your point about the totals box

You said the summary box on the upload step does not serve a purpose where it sits, but that we do need somewhere for a contractor to confirm the total from their own document. Philip agreed it should not be there; where it goes instead is still open. Flagging it so it does not get lost — it was the last thing discussed and no decision was reached.

7 The funnel this morning

MEASURE	COUNT	WHAT IT ACTUALLY COUNTS
Contractor accounts	**51**	Real people, with staff and test accounts excluded. 8 joined in the last 30 hours.
Signed the new terms	**11**	The only ones who can currently use the platform
Must re-sign	**40**	34 on the old agreement, 6 who never signed anything
Applications awaiting a decision	**46**	33 in review, 13 pending — this is your queue
Accepted	**1**	
Client invitations sent	**3**	Ever, in total
Clients who joined	**0**	See the note below

Why "clients who joined" reads zero

Two separate reasons, and both matter.

First, the counter was never wired. The database has a function to record a client accepting an invitation, and nothing in the product ever calls it. So this number would read zero even if clients were joining — which is also why the "client accepted" tile on your pipeline board has always been empty.

Second, of the three invitations ever sent, one went to a test address, one was Vanessa inviting her own personal email, and one went to a genuine third party on 22 October who **never opened it**. So one real client has ever been invited to Groundwork, and they never got in. Worth finding out whether that email was delivered at all — there is currently no way to resend an invitation.

8 Still open

ITEM	OWNER	NOTE
Tell 40 contractors they must re-sign	Ruth	Before they find out themselves
46 applications awaiting a decision	Ruth	Only 1 accepted so far
Disqualification copy	Ruth	Not yet received
Supabase site address setting	Favour / Philip	Dashboard change, fixes the email links

Bill of quantities totals	Favour	Named top priority; in progress
Contractor Privacy Notice	Philip	Referenced in a signed document but does not exist
Partner Agreement has no home	Philip	Nothing collects it since it left onboarding
Automated checks are failing	Favour	8 of them, from yesterday's fast deploys. No real faults found, but they can no longer warn us.
Contractor directory lock	Favour	Staged, not yet shipped

9 Two things about how we work now

Deployments are batched from now on. We found that pushing each small fix separately meant later changes overtook earlier ones, so a fix could sit invisible for minutes and we would "fix" it twice. From now on, small changes are made during a call and held, then released together in one go. Structural work is described, built offline in a block of time, then reviewed.

This is why something may look unfixed when it is not. If you check a change and do not see it, give it a few minutes before reporting it again — several hours yesterday went into re-doing work that had already been done.

10 What I need from you

- **The disqualification message** you mentioned sharing, so applicants who do not qualify get your wording rather than ours.
- **A decision on how we tell the 40 contractors** about re-signing — whether that is you, Vanessa and Periscal, or a message from the platform. I can help draft it.
- **Confirmation on the Privacy Notice** — whether one is being written, or whether the general privacy page is meant to serve.

Anything in here you want in more detail, ask and I will expand it.